came of it and I heard of the rejection of "The Mule" on the thirteenth. Nevertheless, Bradbury was still the future for me. 2

4

The following weeks were spent almost exclusively on job hunting, as I haunted employment agencies and continued to have everyone I know tell me about any place at all in which they might have pull.

For a while, the most hopeful line seemed to be through a fellow student at Columbia, Allan Gray. His father was research director at Wallerstein's, a firm that did research on beer and was particularly interested in the kind of enzymes in yeast, for instance. He promised to mention my name to his father.

I thought beer was a devil of a thing for me to become involved in, but I imagined I would be doing chemical work that might have theoretical interest outside the world of beer—and the firm was in New York —so I said I was interested.

I went to Wallerstein's on February 23. It was on Madison Avenue in the lower thirties and to my great relief, it did not smell of beer. Allan Gray's father was pleasant and decent, quite the reverse of the egregious man at Pfizer, and I liked the laboratory.

I actually thought I had a good chance here but I did not allow that estimate to slow me in my frenetic search.

Dawson, for instance, offered to write a letter to Johns Hopkins where a friend of his was looking for staff members. I wrote a letter and even got Elderfield to write one backing me up.

5

On February 25, 1949, three things happened.

First, a letter from Johns Hopkins was sent to Dawson asking him to send me down to Baltimore for an interview.

Second, a letter had arrived from Boston University asking me to come up to Boston for an interview.

Third, Fred Pohl, not giving up his new urge to be an agent, suggested I let